

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - October 5, 2026

Compiled summary for Monday, October 5, 2026 - focus: continuing the PrahL.dev Portfolio after the October 4 responsive hero, Work Space, workflow-imagery, and first reusable UI/UX showcase record; independently verifying the United States Eastern date; running the customary project reader; extracting and studying all forty-eight pre-existing Portfolio PDF worklogs; rebuilding the landing UI/UX section as a five-decision interactive compact experience while protecting its wide composition; connecting each decision to real Alla Vostra or Cinerific media and project routes; refining decision copy, typography, device geometry, responsive spacing, and connector behavior; consolidating My Workflow from seven entries into four complete phases; adding phase-specific substeps and Deep Diffusion image treatment; revising the Core Beliefs language; maintaining the detached local Next.js preview; validating TypeScript, live routes, interaction, and responsive geometry; documenting committed source states 1c3b63b and 3cdbbc5; refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot; and generating the October 5 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, grouped work-completed sections, committed-source sequence, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Portfolio work performed after portfolio_worklog_october4.pdf and its documentation commit b08e451. The source work is represented by commits 1c3b63b and 3cdbbc5 on main, matching origin/main before this PDF was generated. Together they changed the landing-page decision data, reusable UI/UX showcase component, global responsive styling, workflow structure, workflow image presentation, and Core Beliefs copy. No Hostinger deploy-branch work, GitHub Actions dispatch, static production publish, public deployment, or remote service mutation was performed during this record. The documentation deltas created by this generation pass are the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt file and this root-level October 5 PDF worklog.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Verified the United States Eastern date through an independent UTC-04:00 time query, which reported October 5, 2026 at 11:38 PM. A local America/New_York check immediately before generation reported Monday, October 5, 2026 at 11:41 PM EDT. The filename and title therefore use October 5 rather than the execution host's default date or a UTC rollover.
- Ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt before composing this record, preserving the established source, asset, configuration, Git, PDF-inventory, and workflow-context capture practice.
- Extracted and studied all forty-eight pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDF worklogs with pdftotext and pdfinfo: fifteen July records, fifteen August records, fifteen September records, and the October 1, October 2, and October 4 records. Before this artifact, the series contained 277 PDF pages, 134,370 extracted words, and 1,005,833 extracted characters.
- Compared the full archive for month-name filenames, non-zero-padded day numbers, same-day Part suffix behavior, title and opening-summary construction, source and baseline framing, goal lists, dense technical bullet voice, validation language, files-touched treatment, continuity notes, artifact closure, and repeated dated page footers.
- Used October 4 as the direct chronological baseline because it introduced the reusable six-decision UI/UX showcase and documented the seven-stage image-backed workflow. Used October 2 and October 1 for the current landing, Work Space, hero, navigation, and Cinerific UI Foundations context, while retaining the mature July-through-September conventions for document typography and narrative density.
- Checked all worklog page counts and reviewed representative early, middle, and latest PDF metadata and fonts. The mature artifact convention remains unencrypted US Letter at 612 x 792 points, PDF 1.4, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold, dense black-on-white technical copy, Codex metadata, and a repeated title-and-page footer.
- Reviewed commits 1c3b63b and 3cdbbc5 through git log, git show, commit bodies, file statistics, and final source. Confirmed main and origin/main both resolve to 3cdbbc5290f1dc488a7ba8f51c119a8d9627b404 before the documentation pass.
- Reviewed app/page.tsx, app/UiUxDcDecisionShowcase.tsx, app/globals.css, the relevant Alla Vostra and Cinerific image assets, the refreshed snapshot, and the live landing and project routes as the implementation surface for this record.

Baseline Status Before October 5 Work

- The October 4 state introduced a reusable six-decision UI/UX section with a wide three-left/three-right composition, editable SVG noodles, and a central generic phone frame. Its compact presentation remained a static arrangement rather than a direct-manipulation selector.
- Decision copy still used the initial One Screen. Six Decisions framing and earlier labels such as Clear hierarchy, Reachable Actions, Immediate Feedback, Accessible by default, Consistent Patterns, and Responsible Behavior. Decision 06 was still present in both layout systems.
- The compact layout did not yet provide a persistent five-button rail, a two-times active control,

decision-specific device media, responsive phone-versus-tablet geometry, contextual annotations, or project-route attribution.

- My Workflow still contained seven entries. Research, Plan, Scaffold, and Analyze carried substantive material, while Testing, Building, and Release remained empty placeholders. Desktop tab positioning was designed around the seven-item mirrored sequence.
- Workflow header images retained their earlier brightness, contrast, and desaturation filter. No phase-level A/B/C substep labels appeared beneath the stage banners.
- Core Beliefs still used Modernness and Cohesion in their prior roles, while UI/UX decision 03 used Hierarchical with the three-line immersive and guidance copy.

Goals for October 5

- Reframe the landing UI/UX section around five concise decisions, remove decision 06 completely, and preserve the accepted wide-screen composition while making compact and portrait layouts genuinely interactive.
- Establish a responsive compact control system in which all five decision numbers remain represented, inactive controls fill their allotted horizontal row, and the focused control is exactly twice an individual bottom control's rendered size.
- Give each decision real product context through appropriate Alla Vostra phone captures or the existing Cinerific hero tablet, explanatory copy, and direct project links without duplicating project-page assets.
- Keep compact spacing proportional across device widths, connect the selected bottom control to the active device with the established noodle visual language, and avoid connector clutter between the active and inactive control rows.
- Reduce My Workflow to four complete stages, spread desktop tabs across the available width, label each stage's operational substeps, and apply the approved Deep Diffusion effect without replacing any underlying image.
- Refresh principle language so the landing narrative uses Integrity, Collaboration, and Cohesion in their requested contexts, then validate the final source, live routes, interaction states, and responsive presentation.

Work Completed - UI/UX Philosophy Structure and Copy

- Renamed the section from One Screen. Five Decisions to UI / UX Philosophy and replaced its subtitle with Less 'UI' - More 'You-I', retaining the existing section anchor and overall placement between Featured Case Studies and the technology stack.
- Removed decision 06 from the data and presentation paths. The section now contains five numbered decisions in both wide and compact modes, eliminating the unused sixth control rather than hiding it only at one breakpoint.
- Consolidated the decision titles into Modern, User-friendly, Cohesion, Responsive, and Scalable. Decision 03 was later revised from Hierarchical to Cohesion so the decision taxonomy emphasizes the strength of the full experience rather than hierarchy alone.
- Rewrote the visible supporting copy with intentional line control where appropriate. Modern uses Always sleek, Always streamlined, and Never sleep-inducing. User-friendly uses Instantly legible, Immediately understandable, and Quickly actionable. Responsive uses Every form factor, Every device type, and Piece of cake. Scalable uses Cross-Platform, Cross-Regional, and Consider it done.
- Replaced decision 03's earlier immersive three-line copy with: Let's be real; a product is never stronger than its weakest point. The change moved Cohesion into the UI/UX showcase while preserving a distinct Collaboration principle elsewhere.
- Added a reusable decision-description renderer that respects authored newline boundaries and isolates the final sentence line for italic treatment. This allowed only the requested bottom line of each multi-line statement to carry emphasis rather than italicizing the entire decision block.
- Matched the compact active title's responsive scale to the section heading and matched the active description to the section subtitle scale, keeping hierarchy consistent as the viewport changes.

Work Completed - Compact Decision Selector and Responsive Geometry

- Rebuilt the compact presentation around React state so decisions 01 through 05 are actionable by tap or click. Selecting any bottom-row control updates the focused number, heading, description, media, device annotation, project label, and connector target without navigating away from the landing page.
- Kept all five numbered controls permanently visible in the bottom row even when one is active above. This preserves the complete choice set and gives the active decision both a focused presentation and a stable position within the navigation rail.
- Sized the focused control from the same responsive base measurement as the bottom controls and set it to exactly 2.0 times the individual bottom control's width and height. Live browser measurements at 390px confirmed a rendered 2.00 ratio for every selected state.

- Allowed the five bottom controls to expand responsively across the available horizontal space. Their inter-button spacing matches the strip's left and right padding, preventing edge encroachment while avoiding arbitrary unused gaps.
- Tightened the active-to-bottom-row vertical interval after removing the earlier row-to-row noodles. The remaining device interval is deliberately larger so the control group reads as one cluster before the media begins.
- Removed all connectors between the focused top control and its matching bottom control. Kept one responsive SVG noodle from the selected bottom control's lower edge to the top-center edge of the active device frame, with dots at both endpoints.
- Used a layout effect, element references, and ResizeObserver measurement to derive the compact connector from actual rendered bounds. The noodle therefore follows changing control sizes, phone and tablet frames, and viewport widths rather than relying on one fixed coordinate map.
- Preserved the pre-existing wide composition and its card-to-device connector language outside compact and portrait modes. The interaction-focused rewrite is isolated to the compact panel instead of replacing the established desktop arrangement.

Work Completed - Decision Devices, Context, and Project Routing

- Assigned real Alla Vostra phone captures to decisions 01, 03, and 05: the startup screen, products screen, and confirmed overlay. Each remains inside the existing CSS phone frame and uses project-specific alternative text.
- Assigned the exact Cinerific hero asset, cinerific-hero-tablet-tab-s7-uniform.png, to decisions 02 and 04. Both use a landscape tablet frame matching the landing hero rather than stretching phone geometry around a landscape capture.
- Made phone frames occupy exactly fifty percent of the compact device row's horizontal space and aligned them to the right. Their header and description occupy the remaining left-side area and wrap naturally when space becomes narrow.
- Made tablet frames occupy one hundred percent of the allowed compact device-row width. For tablet decisions, contextual copy moves below the frame rather than competing with the landscape media at its left edge.
- Added AI GENERATIVE and its cookie-cutter implementation statement to decision 01, INTUITIVE INTERFACE and its navigation statement to decision 02, and STEP-BY-STEP VISIBILITY with its focal-layer statement to decision 03.
- Added a horizontally centered PROJECT label beneath every active device. Decisions 01, 03, and 05 identify ALLA VOSTRA and link to /projects/alla-vostra; decisions 02 and 04 identify CINERIFIC and link to /projects/cinerific.
- Styled project names as white actionable text with the established green hover and keyboard-focus treatment, keeping PROJECT as a quieter label while making the destination unmistakable.
- Reused existing repository assets rather than generating substitute screenshots. The phone and tablet variants, source images, context placement, and project destinations are all data-driven through the decision objects.

Work Completed - Workflow Consolidation and Presentation

- Reduced My Workflow from seven stages to four substantive phases: Research, Plan, Produce, and Analyze. Removed the empty Testing, Building, and Release records and their now-unused header-image mappings.
- Renamed Scaffold to Produce so the third phase describes the full implementation outcome rather than only the initial project structure. Its existing workflow narrative and source image remain intact.
- Reworked the timeline selectors from seven-item mirrored nth-child rules to four explicit stage positions. On desktop, the four number-and-title tab pairs span the full row from the left edge through a right-flush Analyze tab without overflow.
- Updated the timeline's vertical guide span and all relevant first-four selectors to match the shorter data set. Portrait rules continue to collapse the tab offsets appropriately rather than inheriting obsolete fifth-through-seventh positions.
- Added compact operational labels under every stage banner. Research now contains A: Discuss, B: Brainstorm, C: Industry Research. Plan contains A: Wireframing, B: Mockups, C: Scaffold. Produce contains A: Build, B: Testing, C: Deployment. Analyze contains A: Handoff and B: Upkeep.
- Rendered the labels from reusable points arrays with generated alphabetic prefixes, semantic ordered-list markup, green prefix color, uppercase white text, responsive wrapping, and consistent spacing before each phase's existing narrative.
- Applied the selected Deep Diffusion treatment to every workflow image while preserving all four pre-existing files. The CSS uses an 11px Gaussian blur, 0.5 brightness, 1.24 contrast, 1.2 saturation, and 1.15 scale to prevent blurred edges from exposing the frame.
- Added a green-to-blue 115-degree atmospheric overlay above the blurred media but below the numbered and

titled tabs. This gives Research, Plan, Produce, and Analyze one cohesive treatment without baking effects into or replacing source images.

Work Completed - Core Beliefs and Narrative Alignment

- Replaced Modernness with Integrity and changed its statement to Underpromise and overdeliver - never the other way around. The existing rose tone and circular belief position remain unchanged.
- Moved the original Cohesion idea into UI/UX decision 03, then renamed the original violet Core Belief to Collaboration with the statement One for all, and all for one.
- Preserved Vision, Inter-connectivity, and User-friendliness as they were. The five-belief star composition, colors, geometry, and responsive behavior were not otherwise rewritten.
- Kept the language changes data-local in app/page.tsx, avoiding layout-specific conditionals and preserving the established reusable principle renderer.

Work Completed - Local Preview and Documentation Continuity

- Maintained the local Next.js preview in the detached portfolio-dev screen session at 127.0.0.1:3000 throughout the implementation and validation sequence.
- Cleared generated development cache only when stale compiled styling was confirmed, moving old .next output to temporary storage before clean restarts rather than deleting broad project paths.
- Built three non-destructive blur previews from the actual Research layout before applying a treatment. The selected Deep Diffusion option was then implemented as CSS across all four workflow images; the temporary preview server and images remained outside tracked project source.
- Refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt after both source commits. The resulting documentation companion records 17,169 lines and 572,503 bytes at final committed application state plus the current worklog inventory.

Committed Source Sequence

- 1c3b63b - Rebuilt the Responsive UI/UX Philosophy Showcase. Reframed the section around five decisions, added the interactive compact selector and measured connector, introduced phone and tablet variants, connected real project media and routes, revised typography and copy, and refreshed the project snapshot.
- 3cdbbc5 - Refined the Workflow and UI/UX Philosophy Sections. Reduced the workflow to four stages, distributed desktop tabs, added stage substeps, applied Deep Diffusion, renamed Scaffold to Produce, revised Integrity and Collaboration, and replaced the Hierarchical UI/UX decision with Cohesion.
- The two commits form one coherent landing-page refinement: the first converted the new UI/UX showcase into a responsive product-linked interaction, while the second simplified the surrounding workflow narrative and aligned the site's principle language.

Validation Summary

- Ran npm run check after the final source changes and again during this documentation pass; TypeScript completed successfully with no emitted files.
- Confirmed main and origin/main both resolve to 3cdbbc5290f1dc488a7ba8f51c119a8d9627b404 before PDF generation. The only working-tree change after the committed application work was the customary refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt.
- Loaded /, /projects/alla-vostra, /projects/cinerific, and /articles through the persistent local server. All four routes returned HTTP 200.
- Used Playwright with the installed Google Chrome binary at 1440px desktop, 390px portrait, and 760px tablet-portrait viewports. Confirmed five wide decision cards, compact-panel visibility only in the intended modes, four workflow items, and all expected substep groups.
- Activated all five compact decisions at 390px. Each state reported a 2.00 focused-to-bottom-control size ratio, the intended phone or tablet class, the correct ALLA VOSTRA or CINERIFIC project label, and the correct project href.
- Confirmed decisions 01, 03, and 05 resolve to phone frames and Alla Vostra, while decisions 02 and 04 resolve to landscape tablet frames and Cinerific.
- Read computed styles for all four workflow images at desktop and portrait widths. Each reported blur(11px), brightness(0.5), contrast(1.24), and saturate(1.2), confirming Deep Diffusion was applied consistently rather than only to Research.
- Earlier browser geometry checks confirmed four desktop workflow tabs span the timeline width with Analyze flush to the right edge and no overflow. Source and runtime checks also confirmed the compact UI/UX panel preserves five bottom choices plus one duplicated focused control.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx - rebuilt compact decision interaction, active-state rendering, multiline

description treatment, phone and tablet frames, contextual copy, project links, and measured bottom-control-to-device connector behavior.

- app/page.tsx - reduced and rewrote UI/UX decision data, mapped project media and routes, consolidated workflow stages and images, added phase substeps, renamed Produce, and revised Integrity, Collaboration, and Cohesion copy.
- app/globals.css - added responsive compact selector geometry, active and inactive control sizing, device-row layouts, phone/tablet presentation, project-link styling, connector spacing, four-stage workflow positioning, substep styling, and Deep Diffusion filters and overlay.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - refreshed through ./read_project.sh so the documentation companion records final committed source state 3cdbbc5 and all forty-eight earlier worklogs.
- portfolio_worklog_october5.pdf - created as the first October 5 Portfolio worklog at the repository root using the established no-Part filename.

Follow-Up Context

- The compact UI/UX selector intentionally renders the active decision twice: once as the two-times focused control and once in the complete five-choice bottom rail. Removing the bottom duplicate would break the requested persistent choice representation.
- Focused-control geometry derives from the responsive bottom-control size. Future ratio changes should preserve that shared variable rather than introduce independent fixed dimensions.
- The only compact noodle runs from the selected bottom control to the device frame. Its endpoint is measured from live element bounds, so future changes to row gaps, device variants, or frame widths should be tested at both narrow and tablet portrait sizes.
- Phone decisions are intentionally right-aligned at fifty percent of the device-row width with context on the left. Tablet decisions intentionally consume the full row and place any context below.
- Project attribution is data-driven. Alla Vostra belongs to decisions 01, 03, and 05; Cinerific belongs to 02 and 04. Their route paths and existing screenshot assets should remain paired unless the content strategy changes.
- Workflow images retain their individual pre-existing source files. Deep Diffusion is entirely CSS-based; removing the filter and overlay restores the originals without an asset migration.
- The four workflow phases are the complete intended set. Desktop placement values assume four tab pairs, while compact portrait behavior deliberately resets their horizontal offset.
- As with prior Portfolio work, ask for the commit message before committing or pushing the refreshed snapshot or this PDF unless the user explicitly supplies a message and requests the operation.

Output Artifact

- Created /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_october5.pdf as the latest daily worklog for Monday, October 5, 2026, following the established month-name, non-zero-padded day, and no-Part first-record naming convention.
- Produced an unencrypted US Letter, PDF 1.4 document using Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold with Codex title, subject, author, creator, and producer metadata.
- Preserved the established dense technical narrative, mature section ordering, repeated dated page footer, and end-of-document continuity notes used by the recent Portfolio worklog series.
- Source state reviewed: 3cdbbc5290f1dc488a7ba8f51c119a8d9627b404 on main and origin/main before snapshot and PDF generation.
- No application-source change, source commit, push, deployment, Hostinger synchronization, GitHub Actions dispatch, or production publish was performed as part of generating this PDF artifact.